

St. Nicholas Orthodox Church, McKinney Texas is reopening with limited attendance.

2nd Sat of Pascha, April 19/May 2, 2020

Instructions on how to sign up for the services

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-02.html>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-02.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-02.doc>

In obedience to the directives of Archbishop Peter, we are reopening the church for a limited number of people. Vladyka has blessed us to re-open in accordance with common sense and the limitations imposed by the CDC and the State of Texas. Because of the social distancing requirement, we cannot open completely, but we are able to invite more people to attend each service, pray and receive the Holy Mysteries. Besides readers, singers, live-casters and cleaners, there will be room for 18 more people in the church. Keep reading to learn how you can sign up to attend. **It is our hope that, as much as possible, whole families will attend together.**

Beginning this coming week (starting on Wednesday, May 6th), we will have at least 3 Liturgies that you can sign up to attend: every Wednesday, Saturday, and Sunday, preceded the previous day by evening services. Please try to prioritize Wednesday, then Saturday, then Sunday when you sign up. If you are able to attend the liturgy on a day other than Sunday, out of consideration to others, please sign up for that liturgy. It may be that we can accommodate everyone in one week, or it might take two weeks. We still must be patient.

Requirements and Restrictions.

You must observe 6' distancing from everybody who does not live in the same house, and some people will be in the attached hall (with the doors propped open). Parents, please do everything you can to keep your children close.

If you have COVID-like symptoms or are in contact with somebody who does, do not attend.

If you are in an at-risk group, please do not attend.

You are not required to wear a mask but you may if that is your desire.

You should prepare for the Liturgy by attending at least some portion of the evening service on the prior day, unless this is completely impossible. If you wish to commune and cannot attend the previous evening service, you must **arrange this in advance** with the serving priest.

If you wish to receive Holy Communion, you should confess in advance and prepare as usual.

Catechumens and non-Orthodox family members are *welcome and encouraged* to sign up and attend.

Some people believe that the most important purpose of the Divine liturgy is to receive the Eucharist. This is not true. The most important purpose of the Divine liturgy is to meet God and experience Him, and become enlightened and changed. The Holy Eucharist is of course central to these things, but without our ardent prayer, we can go away after communing from the liturgy without benefit. That is why it is just as important for catechumens and non-Orthodox family members to come to the liturgy and to pray as it is for Orthodox Christians to commune at the liturgy.

We're using SignUp.com to organize our upcoming SignUps.

Here's how it works in 3 easy steps:

1) Click this link to see our SignUp on SignUp.com: <https://signup.com/go/GmQhOMA>

2) Choose a day, and press the green button, "Sign up".

3) Sign-up using your facebook or google account or by entering your email address. *You will NOT need to register an account or keep a password on SignUp.com*

Note: SignUp.com does not share your email address with anyone. If you prefer not to use your email address, please contact Fr Nicholas or Seraphim and we can sign you up manually.

Yours in Christ, Priest Seraphim and Priest Nicholas